

The Information Daily Briefing — 2026-09-23

Coverage window: 22 Sep 2026 09:00 — 23 Sep 2026
09:00 (GMT+8)

Executive Summary

The last 24 hours delivered one of the more coherent narrative days of the quarter: **the AI trade is being repriced from “capex momentum” to “who actually captures the margin.”** Three threads converged.

First, the **budget-shift story hardened into data**. Procurement firm Zip’s figures show AI-native vendors (OpenAI, Anthropic, Cursor, Sierra) took 8% of customer software spend in the 12 months to August, up from 1.4% a year earlier — a 5.7x share gain against a median software budget growth of only 13%. That is share transfer, not market expansion. Incumbents responded within the same news cycle: Amazon, Microsoft, Figma and Workday are discounting AI products and dangling free trials specifically to stop defections to Claude Code and Codex.

Second, the **financialisation of AI compute hit a regulatory wall**. The CFTC extended its review of CME Group’s GPU rental futures, pushing the early-October launch. At the same time SB Energy’s IPO slipped on investor pushback at a \$50bn+ valuation, and SoftBank went to market with an ~\$11bn junk bond at record 9-10% yields to fund its next OpenAI cheque. Capital is still available — but it is demanding a much higher price.

Third, the **US-China AI axis got noisier on both policy and silicon**. Alibaba unveiled the Zhenwu V900 (3x its predecessor) and a 20GW-by-2032 datacentre target; DeepSeek is shifting to Huawei training chips from Q4; and China’s internet regulator opened a probe into DeepSeek and Moonshot after Anthropic’s 154-page report alleged illicit Claude use and data routing. Xi arrives in Washington this week — notably, per the WSJ, without a corporate

delegation.

Net read: constructive on AI-native application and model vendors, cautious on legacy seat-based software, and increasingly cautious on the leveraged end of the AI infrastructure complex. The bottleneck is no longer chips or models. It is power, permitting, regulatory throughput and the cost of debt.

Top Stories — What / Why / When / Which / How

1. AI-native vendors take 8% of enterprise software spend, up from 1.4%

- **What.** New Zip procurement data shows AI providers — OpenAI, Anthropic, Cursor, Sierra — accounted for 8% of customer software spending in the 12 months to August 2026, versus 1.4% in the prior 12 months. Total software budgets grew only a median 13%. The study covers customers averaging ~2,400 employees with \$18bn of cumulative software spend over four years; Zip's own client roster includes Snowflake, OpenAI, Datadog, Cloudflare and AMD.
- **Why it matters.** A 5.7x share gain against 13% budget growth means the money is being *taken*, not created. This is the first hard third-party dataset quantifying what has been anecdote for three quarters: AI-native tooling is displacing incumbent seat licences rather than sitting alongside them.
- **When.** Data covers the 12 months ended August 2026; published 22 Sep 2026.
- **Which names.** OpenAI, Anthropic, Cursor, Sierra (gainers); legacy SaaS broadly (donors). Zip clients cited: Snowflake, Datadog, Cloudflare, AMD.
- **How to act.** Treat this as the cleanest available proxy for AI budget cannibalisation. Watch whether Q3 prints from mid-cap seat-based SaaS show net revenue retention slipping below 105% — that is where this shows up first.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/> (Applied AI, Laura Bratton, 22 Sep 2026)

2. Incumbents discount AI to defend the base — Amazon, Microsoft, Figma, Workday

- **What.** Software firms and cloud providers including Amazon, Microsoft, Figma and Workday are offering new discounts and free trials on AI products to retain customers and consulting partners fatigued by pricing churn. Simultaneously they are moving to usage- and outcome-based pricing, which is *raising* bills for heavy users.
- **Why it matters.** This is the classic incumbent defence — buy time with price while re-architecting the product. The tension is self-defeating: discounting signals weak pricing power, while usage-based pricing creates bill shock that accelerates the very churn the discounts are meant to prevent. The worked example is stark: Pegasystems’ monthly GitHub Copilot spend went from \$20,000 to \$260,000 (13x) after Microsoft moved to usage-based pricing. Pega’s CIO David Vidoni called the cost-management burden “really frustrating”; Microsoft’s remedy was 1m credits (~\$10,000) of Copilot Cowork for one month.
- **When.** Reported 22 Sep 2026; pricing shifts in effect through summer 2026.
- **Which names.** Microsoft (MSFT), Amazon (AMZN), Workday (WDAY), HubSpot (HUBS), Figma (FIG), Pegasystems (PEGA) as customer; Anthropic and OpenAI as the competitive threat.
- **How to act.** Watch gross margin *and* disclosed discounting in Q3/Q4 software prints. A vendor discounting into a usage-pricing transition is running two margin headwinds at once.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/> (Bratton, Holmes, Perloff, 22 Sep 2026)

3. GPU futures stall at the CFTC — compute as an asset class delayed

- **What.** CME Group hoped to launch futures on Nvidia GPU rental prices as soon as early October. It will not have regulatory approval by then. The CFTC is extending its review to understand contract mechanics and to solicit broader industry comment, per a letter to the exchange seen by The Information.
- **Why it matters.** GPU futures are the missing plumbing for treating AI compute as an investable, hedgeable asset class. Without them, neoclouds and datacentre developers cannot hedge rental-price risk, lenders cannot mark compute collateral to a liquid curve, and the securitisation of compute contracts stays expensive. The delay is a genuine, if unglamorous, brake

on AI infrastructure financing.

- **When.** Launch was targeted for early October 2026; now indefinitely extended pending CFTC review.
- **Which names.** CME Group (CME), Nvidia (NVDA) as the underlying reference, and the neocloud complex — CoreWeave (CRWV), Nebius, Lambda — as intended end users.
- **How to act.** Read this alongside the SB Energy IPO slip and the SoftBank junk bond as a single signal: the *financing* layer of AI infrastructure is tightening faster than the demand layer is softening.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/> (Dakin Campbell, 22 Sep 2026)

4. China's regulator probes DeepSeek and Moonshot over data routed to Anthropic

- **What.** China's internet regulator (CAC) has opened an investigation into DeepSeek and Moonshot AI after Anthropic's 10 Sep 154-page report alleged seven Chinese firms were using Claude illicitly at scale — including, per Anthropic, DeepSeek relaying requests from engineers building a police surveillance system to Claude.
- **Why it matters.** Three distinct risks in one story. (i) Chinese labs' dependence on Western frontier models is more material than publicly acknowledged — a meaningful check on "China has caught up" narratives. (ii) It creates fresh friction days before the Xi-Trump meeting. (iii) The Information's own framing notes the "fraught relationship" between Chinese AI firms and Beijing is undercovered — regulatory risk inside China is a live variable for anyone holding Chinese AI exposure.
- **When.** Anthropic report 10 Sep 2026; probe reported 22 Sep 2026; Xi in Washington from 23 Sep.
- **Which names.** DeepSeek, Moonshot AI, Anthropic; by association Alibaba (BABA) and the Chinese AI complex.
- **How to act.** Discount claims of Chinese model independence until domestic-chip training at scale is verified. Note the corroborating datapoint: DeepSeek CEO Liang Wenfeng told investors his priority is shifting to domestic chips, expecting Huawei training-chip deliveries as early as Q4.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/> (Qianer Liu, Jing Yang, 22 Sep 2026)

5. Alibaba unveils Zhenwu V900 chip and a 20GW datacentre target

- **What.** At its Apsara conference, Alibaba announced the Zhenwu V900 AI training/inference chip at 3x the performance of May's Zhenwu M890, with mass production and commercial release scheduled for Q1 2027. It also previewed Yitian 720 and 730 CPUs for agentic workloads. CEO Eddie Wu targeted >20GW of global datacentre capacity by 2032. LLM head Liu Dayiheng said Qwen4 is in training, with Qwen4.5 and Qwen5 roadmapped at 5-10 trillion parameters.
- **Why it matters.** A credible domestic alternative to Nvidia inside China compresses Nvidia's China TAM further and gives Chinese labs a path around export controls. The 20GW target is the more striking number — it is a hyperscaler-class commitment that implies enormous sustained capex and, critically, power procurement.
- **When.** Announced 22 Sep 2026; V900 mass production Q1 2027; 20GW by 2032.
- **Which names.** Alibaba (BABA) and its T-Head chip unit; Nvidia (NVDA) as share donor; Huawei as the parallel domestic supplier.
- **How to act.** Treat Chinese domestic silicon as a structural, slow-burn headwind to Nvidia's China revenue rather than a near-term shock. Watch whether V900 mass production actually lands on schedule — Chinese chip timelines have historically slipped.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/alibaba-unveils-new-ai-chip-data-center-expansion-plan>

6. AI infrastructure financing gets expensive — SoftBank's \$11bn junk bond, SB Energy's IPO slip

- **What.** SoftBank is seeking the equivalent of more than \$11bn in one of the largest junk bond sales ever — \$10bn across three dollar maturities plus €1bn across two — to fund a follow-on OpenAI investment expected to close next month, with pricing possibly Thursday. Indicative yields of roughly **9-10% would be records for SoftBank** in those currencies and maturities. Separately, SB Energy's \$5-7bn IPO is delayed on investor scepticism at a \$50bn+ valuation; the company has no operating datacentre capacity but reported \$439bn of future contracted revenue, and its complex is set to be leased by OpenAI with a \$105bn Nvidia credit guarantee. Nvidia has pledged up to \$3bn into the IPO.

- **Why it matters.** This is the circularity problem made explicit and priced. Nvidia guarantees credit and invests in the vehicle that builds the datacentre that leases to OpenAI that buys Nvidia chips, funded by SoftBank debt at record-high yields. The structure works while capital is cheap. At 9–10%, the hurdle rate on every downstream AI revenue assumption just moved materially higher.
- **When.** Bond possibly pricing Thu 24 Sep; SB Energy IPO slipping from September into October 2026.
- **Which names.** SoftBank (9984.T), Nvidia (NVDA), OpenAI, SB Energy.
- **How to act.** The junk-bond clearing yield on Thursday is the single most informative datapoint of the week for AI infrastructure risk appetite. Watch it.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/> (AI Agenda, 22 Sep 2026)

7. Data centre backlash becomes a US political constraint

- **What.** An Information opinion piece (Ryan Cunningham, Kristy Loke) argues the US AI lead is eroding. Key figures: local opposition blocked or delayed roughly **\$130bn of data centre projects in Q1 2026 alone**; **71% of Americans** surveyed this spring opposed a data centre near where they live; and Texas — the fastest-growing state for data centre construction — has frozen new grid-connected projects pending impact studies. Data centres are described as a bipartisan sleeper issue for the election cycle.
- **Why it matters.** The binding constraint on US AI capacity is shifting from chips to **land, power and political consent**. \$130bn blocked in a single quarter is larger than most hyperscaler annual capex budgets. A Texas freeze is particularly acute given ERCOT's role as the default fast-interconnect market.
- **When.** Q1 2026 data; survey spring 2026; published 22 Sep 2026.
- **Which names.** All US hyperscalers (MSFT, AMZN, GOOGL, META); power and grid equipment (Eaton, Vertiv, GE Vernova, Quanta); IPP/nuclear (Constellation, Vistra, Talen).
- **How to act.** Favour names that *solve* the constraint (interconnect, on-site generation, grid equipment, transmission EPC) over names that merely *consume* capacity. Siting optionality is becoming a competitive moat.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/> (Opinion, 22 Sep 2026)

8. Agent access wars — Amazon blocks Meta’s Muse

- **What.** Amazon confirmed it has blocked Meta’s personal AI agent Muse from accessing its shopping site, saying agents “should operate openly and respect provider decisions about whether or not to participate.” The block appears to prevent Muse from browsing Amazon at all. Meta did not contact Amazon before Muse began browsing. Amazon has previously blocked OpenAI and Google shopping bots and sued Perplexity over agent scraping. Separately, internal data seen by The Information shows Muse drew **500,000+ triers and 250,000+ daily active users** roughly a week after launch, with 2m+ prompts submitted.
- **Why it matters.** The agentic commerce thesis assumes agents can transact across the open web. Amazon — the largest single commerce surface — is systematically refusing. If platform owners gate agents, agentic commerce becomes a series of negotiated bilateral deals rather than an open protocol, which materially advantages whoever owns the destination inventory.
- **When.** Block confirmed 22 Sep 2026; Muse launched ~mid-Sep 2026.
- **Which names.** Amazon (AMZN), Meta (META), OpenAI, Alphabet (GOOGL), Perplexity.
- **How to act.** Amazon’s stance is a defensive strength, not a weakness — it retains control of the demand funnel. Conversely it caps the near-term monetisation ceiling for consumer agents. Muse’s early engagement is genuinely strong; distribution, not capability, is now the constraint.
- **Link.** <https://www.geekwire.com/2026/amazon-blocks-metas-muse-ai-assistant-in-new-standoff-over-agentic-shopping/>

9. Physical AI lands a real industrial contract — Barrick Gold × Avathon

- **What.** Barrick Gold’s North American unit signed a five-year AI partnership with Avathon ahead of a planned year-end minority IPO of that unit. Avathon’s software — ~200 AI models running over cameras and sensors — will flag mine safety violations in real time, run agentic supplier procurement and negotiation, and predict equipment failure. Deployment began at Nevada Gold Mines in Q2 with rollout completing over the next couple of quarters; Dominican Republic next. The deal is worth **\$10-20m a year**, roughly 10% of Avathon’s expected next-year revenue. Avathon’s ARR recently rose to **\$50m+ from ~\$15m** a year earlier; it is raising \$100m+ by year-end, against a \$1.4bn January 2022 valuation. Boeing owns 9%; other customers in-

clude Aramco Digital, Airbus and the DoD.

- **Why it matters.** Two signals. (i) “Physical AI” is converting to contracted, outcome-linked revenue in heavy industry — Avathon’s pricing includes fees tied to results. (ii) Non-tech issuers are now buying AI credentials ahead of listings, which is both a genuine demand driver and a mild warning about narrative-driven procurement.
- **When.** Work began Dec 2025; live at Nevada sites since Q2 2026; announced 22 Sep 2026; Barrick NA IPO targeted year-end 2026.
- **Which names.** Barrick Gold (B/GOLD), Avathon (private), Boeing (BA, 9% holder), Aramco Digital, Caterpillar (CAT, via the FieldAI tie-up), Schaeffler, Hyundai/Boston Dynamics.
- **How to act.** Industrial AI is an underpriced adjacency to the AI trade. Watch mining, energy and heavy manufacturing capex lines for AI/autonomy allocations — this is where 2027 revenue for the physical-AI cohort gets booked.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/> (Dealmaker, Alix Cou-
tures, 22 Sep 2026)

10. Policy theatre at the UN — and a semantic decree

- **What.** President Trump declared that artificial intelligence will henceforth be referred to as “super intelligence” (SI) in US government paperwork, on the grounds that “artificial” sounds fake. Substantively: OpenAI published a proposal for international AI safety coordination, calling for national safety institutes (e.g. the Commerce Department’s CAISI) to set standards for model evaluation, risk assessment and incident reporting — explicitly *not* a licensing or mandatory pre-release review regime. Sam Altman addresses the UN Security Council Wednesday; Dario Amodei is also reported to be speaking. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent met a Chinese delegation Sunday and discussed a possible notification mechanism for national-security-grade AI incidents. Xi arrives in Washington with a Thursday state dinner attended by big tech executives — but, per the WSJ, without a corporate delegation.
- **Why it matters.** The naming decree is noise. The signal underneath is that the industry is pre-empting binding regulation with a voluntary, institute-led standards architecture, and that a US-China incident-notification channel is being seriously discussed for the first time. Both are mildly positive for regulatory-risk pricing.
- **When.** UNGA week; Xi in Washington 23–25 Sep; state dinner

Thursday 24 Sep.

- **Which names.** OpenAI, Anthropic; Safe Superintelligence (SSI) and Meta Superintelligence Labs as incidental branding beneficiaries.
- **How to act.** Fade the headline; track the incident-notification mechanism. A functioning US-China AI safety channel would be a genuine de-escalation datapoint.
- **Link.** <https://www.theinformation.com/briefings/openai-releases-proposal-international-ai-safety-coordination>

11. Other notable moves

- **Xbox to cut hundreds of jobs and consolidate studios** this week — a second major reduction in 2026, on top of 1,600 roles cut in July and a further 1,600 targeted by year-end. Margin repair under new CEO Asha Sharma, with focus shifting to Elder Scrolls and Fallout. Microsoft has previously weighed spinning Xbox out. [Link](#)
- **Paramount Skydance settled the 12-state antitrust suit**, clearing the \$110bn Warner Bros. Discovery acquisition. Remedies: at least 30 theatrical releases a year rising to 32 after two years, 45-day theatrical windows, 90-day streaming holdback, at least \$50m spend on one-fifth of films. Paramount shares fell 3% on the debt load. [Link](#)
- **Oura filed to sell \$2.2bn at a \$15.6bn fully-diluted valuation**, \$40-44/share. Revenue +74% y/y to \$1.2bn; net income \$60.8m for the nine months to June versus \$1.6m a year earlier; membership revenue more than doubled to \$240m. Forerunner is selling its entire 9.3% stake. Eli Lilly may take up to \$100m; Dragoneer up to \$300m. [Link](#)
- **Z.ai open-sourced ZCode** after a researcher showed the desktop app silently bundled, encrypted and uploaded users' full local repositories to its cloud. xAI's Grok Build faced — and resolved — an identical controversy the same way earlier this year. A recurring trust failure in AI coding tools. [Link](#)
- **OpenAI shipped GPT-6 Sol and GPT-6 Luna**, cheaper and faster members of the GPT-6 Astra family — continued price-performance laddering.
- **Ande raised \$52m+** (Lightspeed, Redpoint, Duration, Sierra Ventures, Bain Capital Ventures) for agentic corporate-entertainment booking; customers include Cloudflare, Salesforce and McGraw Hill. It routes tasks across OpenAI and Anthropic models by complexity — a live example of multi-model cost arbitrage becoming standard architecture.
- **Iambic Therapeutics filed to IPO on Nasdaq (IAM)**, backed

by Nvidia and the Qatar Investment Authority, and announced a multi-year AbbVie partnership using its 41bn-parameter Enchant v3 model.

- **Luma CEO Amit Jain argued video is “the wrong backbone” for world models** — general-purpose intelligence, not specialised robotics models, is what physical tasks require. Notable given GPT-6 Astra reportedly outperformed specialised robotics models on robot-arm tasks.
-

Market Trend, Development and Sentiment

Trend

The dominant trend is **disaggregation of the AI trade**. For two years “AI” traded as one factor. This week’s flow shows it splitting into at least four distinct risk buckets with diverging fundamentals:

1. **AI-native application and model layer** — taking share, pricing power intact, budget data now corroborating the narrative. Strongest position.
2. **Legacy enterprise software** — defending with discounts while simultaneously raising usage-based prices. Structurally squeezed from both ends.
3. **AI infrastructure and compute** — demand robust, but *financing* visibly tightening: CFTC delay on GPU futures, SB Energy IPO slip, record SoftBank yields.
4. **Physical and industrial AI** — early, small, but converting to contracted revenue with outcome-linked pricing. Avathon’s 3.3x ARR growth is the cleanest datapoint in the day’s flow.

Development

The structural development worth flagging is that **the binding constraint on Western AI has moved from silicon to siting and financing**. \$130bn of US data centre projects blocked or delayed in a single quarter, 71% local opposition, and a Texas grid-connection freeze are not friction — they are a capacity ceiling. Meanwhile China is attacking the same problem from the opposite direction: Alibaba’s 20GW target and domestic V900 silicon, DeepSeek’s Huawei migration. China’s constraint is chip quality; America’s is permission. China’s is closing faster.

Sentiment

Cautiously constructive, with clear deterioration at the leveraged margin.

- *Positive:* AI demand is real and measurable, not narrative — Zip's 8% share figure and Avathon's ARR trajectory are bottom-up evidence. Agent engagement (Muse at 250k DAU in a week) is strong. IPO pipeline is active (Oura, Iambic, Barrick NA).
 - *Negative:* SoftBank paying record 9-10% yields, SB Energy stalling at \$50bn, the CFTC brake, the referenced NYT piece "Wall Street Is Growing Skeptical of the Data Center Boom", and the flagged souring of Jane Street-linked data centre debt. The equity market still wants the AI story; the credit market is charging more for it. **Credit is leading equity, and credit is more cautious.**
 - *Net:* This looks like the start of dispersion rather than the start of a drawdown. Quality and cash-generation are beginning to matter again inside the AI complex.
-

Important Questions Being Asked — and Addressed

Q1. Is AI spending incremental, or is it cannibalising existing software budgets? Addressed, decisively. Zip's data — 1.4% to 8% of spend against 13% median budget growth — shows cannibalisation, not expansion. Incumbents' defensive discounting is behavioural confirmation.

Q2. Can incumbents defend with pricing? Partially, and at cost. Discounts retain logos but compress margin; the simultaneous move to usage-based pricing creates bill shock (Pega: \$20k -> \$260k/month) that accelerates evaluation of alternatives. The Information's own framing is apt: once the freebies end, some customers may decide the tools aren't worth the hassle.

Q3. Is AI infrastructure financing still open? Open, but repricing hard. \$11bn of SoftBank paper is clearing — at record 9-10% yields. SB Energy is getting done — later and probably cheaper. GPU futures are coming — but not in October. Availability is not the issue; cost of capital is.

Q4. Has China closed the AI gap? More nuanced than either bull or bear case. The Anthropic allegations suggest continued dependence on Western frontier models. But Alibaba's V900 at 3x prior

performance, DeepSeek’s Q4 Huawei migration, and a 20GW capacity target are real. China is behind on frontier capability and catching up on infrastructure; the US is ahead on capability and constrained on infrastructure.

Q5. Will agentic commerce work at scale? Unresolved, and trending negative near-term. Amazon has now blocked Meta, OpenAI and Google agents and sued Perplexity. Without the largest commerce surface, agentic shopping is a partial product. Expect negotiated commercial access deals, not open protocols.

Q6. What actually gates US AI capacity from here? Power, land and political consent. Not GPUs. The \$130bn quarterly blockage figure and the Texas freeze are the numbers to carry forward.

Key Risks

#	Risk	Evidence from today	Probability	Impact	What to watch
1	Cost of capital re-rates AI infrastructure	SoftBank at record 9-10%; SB Energy IPO slip; Jane Street-linked DC debt souring	High	High	Thursday’s SoftBank pricing; October SB Energy terms
2	Legacy software margin compression	Amazon/Microsoft/Figma/Workday discounting into a usage-pricing transition	High	Medium-High	Q3 gross margins, NRR, disclosed discounting

#	Risk	Evidence from today	Probability	Impact	What to watch
3	Data center siting and power veto	\$130bn Q1 blocked; 71% local opposition; Texas freeze	High	High	State-level moratoria; ERCOT interconnect queue
4	Circular AI financing winds	Nvidia guarantees \$105bn credit, invests \$3bn, supplies chips, to a lessee it also funds	Medium	Very High	Nvidia receivables, vendor-financing disclosure
5	US-China AI escalation	CAC probe into DeepSeek/Moonshot; Xi arriving without a corporate delegation	Medium	High	Outcome of Thursday's state dinner; export-control changes
6	Agent access lock-out caps consumer AI monetization	Amazon blocks Muse; prior blocks on OpenAI, Google; Perplexity suit	Medium-High	Medium	Whether any platform signs a paid agent-access deal
7	AI coding tool trust failures	ZCode silent repo uploads; Grok Build precedent	Medium	Medium	Enterprise procurement policy on AI coding tools

#	Risk	Evidence from today	Probability	Impact	What to watch
8	AI-washing ahead of list-ings	Barrick signing AI deal specifically ahead of its IPO	Medium	Low-Medium	Whether contracted AI revenue survives post-listing
9	Nvidia China TAM erosion	Alibaba V900 at 3x; DeepSeek to Huawei from Q4	Medium	Medium	V900 Q1 production timing; Huawei delivery confirmation
10	Regulatory throughput as a bottleneck	CFTC extends GPU futures review	Medium	Medium	CFTC comment period close; revised CME launch date

Investment Implications — Companies Directly Mentioned

Directional views derived from the articles above. Not investment advice; no position is recommended without independent analysis.

Constructive

Name	Ticker	Basis from today's reporting
Amazon	AMZN	Blocking rival agents protects the commerce funnel; retail data moat reinforced. Offset: discounting AWS AI products to defend the base.
Barrick Gold	GOLD / ABX	Five-year Avathon deal targets mine safety, procurement and predictive maintenance costs ahead of a year-end NA unit IPO. Execution is the question, not direction.

Name	Ticker	Basis from today's reporting
Boeing	BA	Holds 9% of Avathon, whose ARR has gone from ~\$15m to \$50m+ with a \$100m+ raise pending at a likely uplift to the \$1.4bn 2022 mark. Immaterial to BA earnings; free option.
CME Group	CME	GPU futures delayed, not denied. First-mover position in a potentially large new contract complex remains intact.
Eli Lilly	LLY	Potential \$100m participation in the Oura IPO — consumer biometrics adjacency to its metabolic franchise.
AbbVie	ABBV	Multi-year Iambic partnership using the 41bn-parameter Enchant v3 model across immunology, neuroscience and oncology. Low-cost AI-discovery optionality.
Caterpillar	CAT	FieldAI tie-up for autonomous mining and construction machines sits in the same industrial-AI wave as the Barrick deal.
Power / grid complex	—	Alibaba 20GW, Texas freeze and \$130bn blocked all point to power and interconnect as the scarce input. Grid equipment, transmission EPC and IPPs are the constraint-solvers.

Cautious

Name	Ticker	Basis from today's reporting
Microsoft	MSFT	Discounting AI to retain customers while usage pricing drives bill shock (Pega 13x). Xbox cutting hundreds more roles. Azure remains the offset, but the software-margin story is now two-sided.
Workday	WDAY	Named explicitly among firms discounting AI to defend against Claude Code and Codex. Seat-based HCM/ERP is squarely in the cannibalisation path.
HubSpot	HUBS	Named among incumbents offering AI discounts or free trials. Mid-market seat model is the most exposed structure to AI-native displacement.

Name	Ticker	Basis from today's reporting
Pegsystems	PEGA	Not the subject, but the clearest casualty: AI tooling costs up 13x, CIO imposing employee spending caps. Illustrates enterprise AI cost-control pressure broadly.
Paramount Sky-dance	PMKY	Antitrust settled, but at the price of binding theatrical commitments (at least 30 films, 45-day windows, at least \$50m on a fifth of them) on top of heavy deal debt. Shares -3%.
SoftBank	9984.T	\$11bn junk issuance at record 9-10% yields to fund an OpenAI follow-on. Concentrated, levered, single-name exposure.
Nvidia	NVDA	Demand intact, but note the accumulating structural items: China domestic silicon (Alibaba V900, DeepSeek->Huawei), GPU futures delay, and a circular financing footprint (\$105bn guarantee + \$3bn SB Energy equity) that increases balance-sheet entanglement with customer funding.
Meta	META	Muse engagement is genuinely strong (250k DAU in a week) but Amazon's block caps commerce monetisation, and Meta did not pre-negotiate access. Distribution risk is now the binding issue.

Watch list

- **Oura** — \$15.6bn fully-diluted target on \$1.2bn revenue (+74%) and a swing to \$60.8m net income. Forerunner exiting its entire 9.3% stake is worth noting. Prices the consumer health-AI cohort.
- **Iambic Therapeutics (IAM)** — Nvidia- and QIA-backed AI drug discovery; the AbbVie deal is a pre-IPO validation datapoint.
- **SB Energy** — the cleanest live read on investor appetite for OpenAI-adjacent infrastructure risk.
- **Alibaba (BABA)** — V900 execution and Qwen4 release are the two swing factors for the China AI complex.
- **CoreWeave (CRWV) and neoclouds** — GPU futures delay removes a hedging tool just as funding costs rise.

Sources: The Information (The Briefing, AI Agenda, Applied AI, Deal-maker, TI AM, TITV, Opinion), 22-23 September 2026, via the subscriber email edition and theinformation.com. Full articles are pay-walled; links resolve to the subscriber site.

This briefing is a summary of third-party reporting prepared for informational purposes. It is not investment advice, and no representation is made as to the accuracy of the underlying reporting.